OWNER OPERATIONS HANDBOOK

Using the Vistar Cabs admin panel

A practical, click-by-click guide to website content and the business tools available in the admin workspace.

Made for the Vistar Cabs owner
Short, practical instructions. Follow the steps on screen; no coding is needed for the admin tasks in this guide.

Inside this guide

- Sign in safely and understand owner versus SEO editor access
- Handle every admin section, including enquiries and fleet records
- Create and update pages, photos, feedback and campaigns
- Know when a saved admin change is live and when GitHub deployment is needed

Website: vistarcabs.com
Admin workspace: vistarcabs.com/vistar-console

1. Sign in and find your way

1. Open **vistarcabs.com/vistar-console**. For local development, use **http://localhost:3000/vistar-console**.
2. Sign in with the account given to you. Never put your password in a page, note, screenshot or GitHub commit.
3. Check the role shown at the top. The owner account can access business records. An SEO editor account only sees website tools.
4. Choose a section from the navigation. On a narrow phone screen, swipe/scroll the section menu sideways to find more items.
5. Use the refresh icon to reload the current view. Use **Sign out** when done, especially on a shared computer.

The admin session expires after eight hours. If a save stops working, sign in again and retry. Never share the account password to troubleshoot.

What saves where?

Change type	Where it is saved	Does it need a GitHub deploy?
Feedback, page content, campaign, settings and records	Admin API/database	No. Save it in admin and check the result.
Layout, colors, fields, new feature or admin behavior	Project source code	Yes. Code is built and deployed through the project workflow.
Hostinger/backend settings	Hosting configuration	Not through the content editor. Follow the hosting guide.

2. What each section is for

Admin section	Use it to...	Access
Overview	See counts and shortcuts. A dash or red error means data did not load.	Owner and SEO
Performance	Review recorded activity in the 30-day or 90-day view.	Owner and SEO
Inquiries	Search customer requests and track follow-up as new, contacted or closed.	Owner
Website Pages	Find built-in pages, edit supported content, create CMS pages and restore revisions.	Owner and SEO
SEO settings	Set search title, description, canonical path and noindex for an existing route.	Owner and SEO
Site campaigns	Create an on-site banner with text, image, link, dates and status.	Owner and SEO
Customer feedback	Add real customer-approved quotes; publish, edit or archive them.	Owner and SEO
Photo library	Upload images and copy their IDs into supported editors.	Owner and SEO
Customers	Keep service contacts, tags and private notes. Marketing consent stays off unless agreed.	Owner
Corporate duty slips	Prepare, update, print and track company trip slips.	Owner
Vehicles	Maintain private fleet details and availability.	Owner
Drivers	Maintain contact, home city, assigned vehicle and status.	Owner
Site settings	Update public contact details, hours, social links and coverage.	Owner and SEO
Change history	See recent admin actions, who made them and when.	Owner

The admin is a content and records tool, not a visual page designer. If there is no field or button for the change you need, ask for a code change.

3. Inquiries: review and follow up

1. Open **Inquiries**. Search by the customer name, phone number or route. Use the status filter to show all, new, contacted or closed.
2. Open a request and check the name, callback number, service type, origin, destination, travel date/time and trip type.
3. For an airport enquiry, check pickup/drop direction, flight and terminal details. For a return, check the return date/time. Read customer notes.
4. Tap/click the phone number to call from a device that supports calling.
5. After follow-up, set status to **Contacted**. When the request is fully handled, use **Closed**. Leave new requests as **New** until someone follows up.

Changing an enquiry status is only a tracking note. It does not call the customer, send a message, quote a fare or book a vehicle.

Quick daily routine

- Open the New filter at the start of the day.

- Call or message the customer using the business process.
- Record the follow-up by changing the status.
- Check that the team has directly confirmed vehicle, complete fare and trip terms.

4. Customer feedback: add, edit or take down

Feedback must be genuine. Ask the customer for permission to show the exact words and chosen display name. Do not invent, combine or strengthen a quote.

Add a review

1. Open **Customer feedback**. In **Approved display name**, enter the name the customer agreed to show.
2. Choose the rating the customer actually gave (1 to 5).
3. Paste the exact approved words in **Exact customer feedback**. The quote must be 15 to 1,200 characters.
4. Optionally enter a short **Trip label**, such as "Airport transfer". Do not include private details.
5. For review before publishing, set **Publication** to **Draft**. To publish now, select **Published**. Select **Archived** to keep it off the public site.
6. Tick the consent box confirming approval for this exact quote and display name. It is required.
7. Press **Save feedback**. Wait for the success message. Open the public home page and check the feedback area.

Published feedback may take about one minute to appear. The public site only shows published feedback with consent confirmed.

Edit or remove

1. In Feedback records, choose **Edit**, make the correction and press **Update feedback**. Confirm consent again if asked.
2. To take a quote off the site, edit Publication to **Archived** and save.
3. The **Remove** button archives the record; it is not a permanent delete. Use it when you want the quote hidden and retained in records.

Why the dropdown has three choices: the backend accepts Draft, Published and Archived. Scheduled was not a valid feedback status, so it could not be saved; it has been removed from this feedback form.

5. Website Pages: edit existing content

1. Open **Website Pages** and choose **Browse pages**. Search by city, route, airport or page name. Confirm the path before opening it.
2. Choose **Edit content** for the correct built-in page. The URL of a built-in page is fixed.
3. Write short, useful sections with clear headings. Check spelling, travel details, links and image alt text.
4. Choose **Add sections to current page** to keep the designed page and append saved content. Choose **Replace main page body** only when you intend to replace the main content.
5. Preview the content and save. The admin preview shows the editable content; it is not a full preview of the responsive page design.
6. After publishing, use **Open live page**. Check the page on a phone and a computer.

Replacing the main page body can substantially change what visitors see. Use Draft first if another person needs to review it.

Create a new CMS page

1. In Website Pages, open **Create / manage CMS pages** and select the create-page option.
2. Set the page URL slug carefully. It is locked after the page is first saved.
3. Enter page title, H1 heading, search title, search description and a short introduction.
4. Add sections: give each a clear heading and practical body text. Add FAQs only when they answer real visitor questions.
5. For an image, upload it in Photo library first, then enter its image ID and accurate alt text. Use a verified internal path or HTTPS link.
6. Save as **Draft** while reviewing. Choose **Published** to publish now, or schedule only when the page is ready and the future date/time is correct.
7. Open the live URL, usually **/pages/your-slug**, then check on mobile.

Archive or restore

- Archiving a CMS page hides it from visitors but keeps its record.
- Archiving a built-in page edit removes the saved override and returns the page to its coded template; the URL remains.
- Use Revision history to review versions. Restore the right one; the current version is saved to history first. Check status and preview after restoring.

6. Photo library: upload and reuse

1. Open **Photo library** and choose a JPG, PNG or WebP file no larger than 4 MB.
2. Write **Accessible alt text** that describes the image for a person who cannot see it.
3. Press **Upload image**. When it appears in the library, choose **Copy image ID**.
4. Open the page, campaign or vehicle editor. Paste the ID into its image field and enter alt text if provided.
5. Save the item, then check that the image looks correct on mobile and desktop.

Only upload images Vistar Cabs owns or has permission to use. Deleting an image can break pages or banners that use it; check its use before deleting.

7. SEO settings: update search details

1. Open **SEO settings** and select the exact existing page path.
2. Write a clear search title (up to 70 characters) and a true description of that page.
3. Keep the canonical path set to the correct page URL. The focus phrase is an editing aid.
4. Use **noindex** only when search engines should not list the page. Do not turn it on for a normal public page without a reason.
5. Save and check the page. Removing an SEO override returns the page to its template/default metadata.

SEO fields do not guarantee a search ranking, indexing, traffic or a particular position.

8. Site campaigns: make a website banner

1. Open **Site campaigns** and choose to create a campaign.
2. Enter an internal name for the team, then the public headline, short message and button label.
3. Set the button destination to a site path such as **/airport-taxi** or a verified HTTPS URL.
4. Optionally choose an image from the photo library and provide alt text.
5. Set a start/end date if needed. Choose priority from 0 to 100; a higher number gives the banner higher priority.
6. Save as Draft while checking. Set Active when ready. Check the home page during the date window.
7. Use Paused to temporarily hide it or Archived when it is no longer needed.

This creates a banner on the Vistar Cabs website. It does not create paid advertising on Google or social media.

9. Site settings: public contact and service details

1. Open **Site settings**. Update only details the owner has verified.
2. Check public phone numbers and WhatsApp number carefully. Enter WhatsApp country code plus digits only, without spaces or punctuation.
3. Enter the correct email address, social profile URLs, operating hours and service coverage summary.
4. Leave a social field blank if that profile should not be shown.
5. Save, then open the site and test each public phone, email and social link.

10. Customers: keep a service contact record

1. Open **Customers** and add the customer name and phone number when there is a real service need.
2. Add brief tags separated by commas and only relevant service notes.
3. Leave marketing consent off unless the customer explicitly agreed to marketing messages.
4. Save and check the record. Limit access and do not put passwords, card numbers, identity scans or unrelated private information in notes.

11. Corporate duty slips: prepare, complete and print

Before the trip

1. Open **Corporate duty slips**. Enter company name, guest/passenger name and phone. Add the coordinator and number if provided.
2. Enter trip date, pickup time, exact pickup/drop addresses, itinerary, assigned driver/phone and vehicle type/number.
3. Set status to **Prepared**. Save with **Create duty slip**.
4. Find the saved slip and choose **Print / PDF**. In the print dialog, select "Save as PDF" if you need a PDF copy, or select a printer.

After the trip

1. Find the slip and choose **Complete / edit**.
2. Enter actual start/end KM and start/end time. Add trip amount, toll and parking amounts, payment terms and remarks.
3. Set the correct status: Completed, Submitted, Approved or Cancelled based on the company process.
4. Choose **Save trip updates**. Print / PDF again to review the completed slip.
5. Use **Delete** only when the slip is truly an incorrect duplicate or should be removed under the owner records process.

Check guest and driver phone numbers, date, route, kilometre readings and amounts carefully before sharing a printed slip.

12. Drivers and vehicles

Drivers

1. Open **Drivers** and create or edit the driver record.
2. Enter driver name, phone, home city, assigned vehicle, availability/status and short internal notes.
3. Save. Update status and assignment when they change so the owner can find current information.

Vehicles

1. Open **Vehicles** and create or edit a vehicle record.
2. Enter display label, make/model, category, seat and luggage details, registration number, home city and status.
3. If adding a photo, upload it to Photo library first; paste the image ID and accurate alt text.
4. Save and keep maintenance/availability status accurate.

Driver and vehicle records are private admin records. They do not create a public live-booking system or automatically assign a cab to an enquiry.

13. Performance and Change history

Performance

Open **Performance** and choose the 30-day or 90-day view. Use the numbers as a summary of recorded website activity. They are not a guarantee of future bookings.

Change history

Open **Change history** to see recent actions, the type of item changed, the admin account/role and the time. Use it to understand who changed something. It is an audit list, not a restore button for every kind of record.

14. Fix common admin problems

Problem	Try this
Red API or empty-response warning	Refresh once. If it remains, admin has not received the JSON it expects. Check that the frontend/API and backend deployment are running. Do not edit MongoDB or paste private connection settings into chat.
Sign-in fails	Check the account and role. Ask the owner to check backend availability. Never send the password.
Save fails	Read the on-screen message. Check required fields, formats and consent. If the session expired, sign in again and retry.
Feedback not visible	Check Published status and consent, wait about one minute, refresh the public page.
CMS page not visible	Check Published status, correct URL slug, and scheduled publication time.
Campaign missing	Check Active status, date window, priority and homepage link.
Phone/email link is wrong	Correct Site settings, save, and test the public link.
Page needs a new layout or field	This needs a code change. Update the project, build and deploy through GitHub/Hostinger.

15. Owner safe publishing checklist

- Confirm you are editing the right page or record.
- Check spelling, city, distance, route, date, phone and link.
- Use truthful claims; confirm fares, schedules, operating hours and service promises with the business.
- Get permission for a customer name and exact feedback before publishing.
- Use Draft for content that needs a second review.
- After publishing, open the live page on a phone and a computer.
- Admin content saves through the API. Code/layout changes need GitHub/Hostinger deployment.
- Keep customer, driver and company trip information private.

If a button or field is not present, stop before improvising with a database or source file. Note the page, the change you need and what you expected; then ask for the correct code update.